Apex Systems - Response to RFP-2026-017

Cloud-native engineering for regulated enterprises | Fictional document for classroom use

1. Executive Summary and Understanding of the Requirement

Meridian Manufacturing Ltd requires a Supplier Portal and Procurement Workflow Platform (RFP-2026-017) to onboard suppliers, manage sourcing events and automate approvals. Apex Systems proposes a cloud-native platform built on a microservice architecture running on Kubernetes across two cloud regions, giving high availability and horizontal scalability. We understand that Meridian needs tight ERP integration and strong controls over supplier data.

2. Proposed Solution and Implementation Approach

Architecture: An API gateway fronts independent microservices for onboarding, sourcing, contracts and approvals. Prebuilt integration connectors exist for SAP S/4HANA and Oracle ERP, with SSO through SAML 2.0 and OIDC.

Scalability: The platform was load tested to 5,000 concurrent users with response times under 800 ms. Autoscaling policies and a documented high availability design (99.95% target) are included in Appendix A.

Approach: Delivery follows six phases from discovery to hypercare, with an integration test environment mirroring Meridian's ERP landscape.

3. Timeline, Team Structure and Milestones

Phase	Duration	Milestone
Discovery & design	4 weeks	Signed architecture
Core build	10 weeks	Portal + workflow beta
ERP integration	6 weeks	SAP connector live
Testing & UAT	4 weeks	UAT sign-off
Go-live	2 weeks	Production release
Hypercare	2 weeks	Handover

Nine specialists: a delivery manager, solution architect, four engineers, a security engineer and a QA lead. Total duration is 28 weeks with go-live in week 28. A risk register is reviewed fortnightly.

4. Price Table and Assumptions

Item	Amount
Implementation (fixed price)	USD 412,000
Annual licence (per year)	USD 96,000
Hypercare & training	USD 28,000
Total cost, year 1	USD 536,000

Assumptions: Assumes up to 300 suppliers at launch, two ERP connectors, and Meridian providing a UAT team. Change requests are charged at USD 1,100 per day. Payment in four milestones.

5. Security, Compliance and Risk Controls

Apex holds ISO 27001 and SOC 2 Type II certifications, renewed annually.

Data is encrypted at rest (AES-256) and in transit (TLS 1.3). MFA and role-based access control (RBAC) are enforced for all users.

Immutable audit logs are retained for seven years under a documented data retention policy. An independent penetration test and continuous vulnerability scanning are performed annually. A GDPR data processing agreement is provided.

Risk management: Key risks are ERP data quality and UAT availability; both are mitigated through early data profiling and a named Meridian product owner.

6. Support Model, Experience and References

Support desk operates 8x5 (business hours) with a 4-hour SLA for priority 1 incidents. Apex has delivered two similar procurement portals in the last four years.

References: One reference client is available on request; contact details are not included in this response.